Name: .....
ID: .....

Section: .....

AOU
الجامعة العربية المفتوحة
Arab Open University
Faculty of Language Studies

Arab Open University

FACULTY OF LANGUAGE STUDIES

EL122
Writing Research
Main- All Branches
MTA Exam
Spring Semester 2026
Date: 15 April 2026
9:30 – 11:00

Number of Exam Pages: 7 (including this cover sheet)	**Time Allowed:** 1.5 ho

Instructions

e sure you complete all the necessary information such as your name, your registra
ır section number on this cover sheet
exam has 3 parts
ers must be written neatly and legibly
d some time at the end to revise your spelling and grammar

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This exam consists three parts. Please check the following table for grade computat

Part A	/15	
Part B	/8	
Part C	/7	
Total	/30	

PART A: [15 Points]

Read the following passage and respond to the prompts that follow it:

In recent years, the rise of remote work has transformed traditional ideas about productivity and workplace structure. Many employees now have the flexibility to work from home, allowing them to save time on commuting and achieve a better balance between professional and personal life. Companies have also benefited from reduced operational costs and access to a wider global workforce. As a result, remote work has become an attractive option for both employers and employees across various industries. However, this shift has also introduced new challenges that cannot be ignored. Some workers report feelings of isolation, decreased collaboration, and difficulty separating work from personal life. Employers, on the other hand, struggle to maintain team cohesion and monitor productivity effectively. While remote work offers significant advantages, its long-term success depends on finding strategies that preserve communication, accountability, and employee well-being.

Rania Haddad, "Redefining Work in the Digital Age."

1. What is the topic of this passage? [2 Points]

_____

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2. Write a suitable title for the passage. [1 Point]

_____

3. Write a research question for the passage. [2 Points]

_____

_____

4. Write a one-sentence summary of this passage. [3 Points]

_____

_____

5. Write a response to this passage. [4 Points]

_____

_____

_____

_____

_____

6. Paraphrase the following sentence from the passage: "Companies have also benefited from reduced operational costs and access to a wider global workforce. As a result, remote work has become an attractive option for both employers and employees across various industries." [3 Points]

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PART B: [8 Points]

1. Pick one of the following topics and write a rough outline for a potential research essay. [6 Points]

- The effects of remote work on productivity and employee well-being.
- The role of public transportation in sustainable cities.
- The impact of globalization on local cultures.

2. Write a thesis statement for the outline that you developed in the previous question. [2 Points]

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PART C: [7 Points]

Respond to the following prompts:

1. For each thesis statement, identify the problem and rewrite the thesis statement to be more effective. [2 Points Each]

a. Technology is very useful in our lives.

Problem:

Revised Thesis:

b. Cities have many problems today.

Problem:

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Revised Thesis:

_____

_____

2. Here is an original sentence and two paraphrases of it. For each paraphrase, decide if it meets all three criteria for a good paraphrase. If there is a problem, identify it and then rewrite the paraphrase to make it more effective. [3 points]

Original:

"Urban green spaces improve mental health by reducing stress and encouraging social interaction."
— Khaled Mansour, Cities and Well-being (2021)

Paraphrase 1:

Mansour (2021) argues that parks and green areas in cities help people feel less stressed and interact more with others.

Does the paraphrase meet all three criteria? Yes / No [0.5 points]

If no, what is the problem? _____ [0.5 points]

Rewrite to improve: _____

(student should indicate if no rewriting is needed). [0.5 points]

Paraphrase 2:

Green spaces are nice places where people like to go and relax sometimes.

Does the paraphrase meet all three criteria? Yes / No [0.5 points]

If no, what is the problem? _____ [0.5 points]

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Rewrite to improve: _____

(student should indicate if no rewriting is needed). [0.5 points]

End of Exam

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